

WELCOME TO THE DISCWORLD

A quick primer for players new to Terry Pratchett's world

TONE: dry, sarcastic, full of puns. Common sense is rare, so be polite to anyone carrying an axe, and never ask what's in the sausage.

THE DISC

A flat world, balanced on the backs of **four elephants**, who stand on the shell of a giant turtle (**Great A'Tuin**) swimming through space. Everyone here thinks this is perfectly normal. It's fantasy, but with the clichés poked until they squeak.

- **Narrative Causality:** stories *want* to happen. One-in-a-million chances come up nine times out of ten, and the funnier or more dramatic option usually wins. Lean in.
- **Magic is real and can do anything, but should it?** If it results in something interesting it will probably cooperate, but never without some sort of mishap. Clever wizards quickly learn to use it only in times of need.
- **Directions:** there's no north or south. Travel is **hubwards** (toward the Disc's centre), **rimwards** (toward the edge), **turnwise** (with the Disc's spin) or **widdershins** (against it).
- **Belief is power.** Gods, ideas and monsters exist because enough people believe in them.

ANKH-MORPORK

The biggest, smelliest, most cosmopolitan city on the Disc, and the home of nearly everyone you'll play. Sits on the **River Ankh**, so polluted it's crunchy, and you can almost walk across. Every species lives here, and gets along because everyone is equally mistrusted.

- **Lord Vetinari, the Patrician**, rules the city: a thin, calm, terrifying tyrant who is both feared *and* respected, and who somehow keeps the whole mess running. You do not want him to take an interest in you.
- **The Guilds run everything.** Rather than fight crime, the city regulates it:
 - **Thieves:** licensed, with a yearly quota. Pay your dues and you get a receipt, and nobody else will rob you.
 - **Assassins:** gentlemen and ladies of taste, with a dress code and rules of engagement. Murder is a profession like any other.
 - **Beggars:** licensed pitches and a strict pecking order. Don't even *think* of poaching a corner.
 - **Fools:** clowns and jesters, professionally trained. Funnier than they look, and pies are serious business.
 - **Seamstresses:** not to be confused with "needlewomen" (those who actually mend textiles). The guild instead provides ladies of negotiable affection.
- **The City Watch** is run by **Commander Vimes** and recruits from every species in the city. The members range from sharp to sleepy, and they're underfunded and rarely taken seriously (except by the criminals).
- **Unseen University** is where the wizards live, eat enormous meals, and are carefully ignored. The Librarian is an orangutan.

YOU ARE A GOLEM



Drawn by [Steven Player](#)

- **What you are:** a figure of baked clay, made by priests who weren't great sculptors, and animated by the **chem**: a scroll of words (scripture or instructions) sealed in your head. No new golems have been made for hundreds of years, so you're probably patched and mended.
- **Body:** most golems lack the ability to talk and typically **communicate through writing**, with chalk and slate. Fun tip: write your lines on cards. You don't sleep, eat, or need shelter, and you never get tired.
- **Obedience:** while still under contract, you follow instructions *to the letter*: golems have washed dishes so thin you can see through them, and pumped a handle every eight seconds for 240 years.
- **Society:** many see you as a thing, not a person. You do the jobs even trolls won't. But times are changing: the **Golem Trust** buys golems their freedom and the free ones save to buy more. A quiet revolution.
- **Stereotypes:** *calm, formal, gentle, relentlessly literal and patient*. Answers in short slate-sized messages and never leaves a task half-done.
- **Names:** old ones are named for gods or ideas (Anghammarad, Dorlf); newer ones for their job (Pump 19) or from a kindly former owner.